

RRB NTPC High-Yield History MCQ Bank

Cross-Over Questions from SSC CGL, CHSL, and State PSC Exams

Target: Buddhism, Jainism, and The Sangam Age

Q1. Match the following major events of Gautama Buddha's life with their traditional artistic symbols and choose the correct option:

- 1. Birth — A. Stupa**
- 2. Mahabhinishkramana (Renunciation) — B. Wheel (Dharmachakra)**
- 3. Nirvana (Enlightenment) — C. Lotus and Bull**
- 4. Dharmachakrapavattana (First Sermon) — D. Horse**
- 5. Mahaparinirvana (Death) — E. Bodhi Tree**

[A] 1-C, 2-D, 3-E, 4-B, 5-A

[B] 1-C, 2-E, 3-D, 4-B, 5-A

[C] 1-B, 2-D, 3-E, 4-C, 5-A

[D] 1-A, 2-D, 3-E, 4-B, 5-C

Exam Source: SSC CGL (2022, 2024), UPSC CDS (2021), highly expected for RRB NTPC CBT-2.

Correct Answer: [A]

Detailed Explanation: Each key milestone in Gautama Buddha's life is associated with a specific symbolic representation in early Buddhist art: Birth is represented by the Lotus & Bull; the Great Renunciation (leaving his palace on his horse Kanthaka) by the Horse; Enlightenment by the Bodhi Tree (Peepal tree under which he meditated); the First Sermon at Sarnath by the Wheel (turning the wheel of law); and his Death/Decease by the Stupa (relic mound).

Q2. Which core doctrinal concept is strictly advocated by Jainism but explicitly modified or rejected by early Buddhist philosophy?

[A] Faith in the theory of Karma and rebirth

[B] Rejection of the absolute authority of the Vedas

[C] The concept of Anatma (Non-existence of a permanent soul) and practice of extreme self-mortification

[D] The pursuit of liberation from the cycle of worldly existence

Exam Source: SSC CGL Tier-2 (2023), Bihar SSC Inter Level (2024), dynamic shift matching RRB NTPC analytical patterns.

Correct Answer: [C]

Detailed Explanation: While both systems rejected Vedic authority and accepted Karma, they differed fundamentally on the soul and asceticism. Jainism asserts that everything (including inanimate objects) has a soul (Jiva) and advocates rigid asceticism/penance (like Sallekhana). Buddhism explicitly rejects an eternal soul (Anatta/Anatma) and promotes the Madhyamaka (Middle Path), avoiding extreme asceticism.

Q3. The first major internal schism in the Buddhist monastic order, splitting it into Sthaviravadins (Elders) and Mahasanghikas (Great Community), occurred during which Buddhist Council?

- [A] First Buddhist Council at Rajagriha
- [B] Second Buddhist Council at Vaishali
- [C] Third Buddhist Council at Pataliputra
- [D] Fourth Buddhist Council at Kundalavana

Exam Source: BSSC CGL, MPPSC Prelims, targeted directly at candidates who confuse early splits with the later Hinayana/Mahayana divide.

Correct Answer: [B]

Detailed Explanation: The Second Buddhist Council, held at Vaishali around 383 BCE under King Kalasoka, witnessed the first major structural split. The dispute arose over ten minor monastic rules (Vinaya). The orthodox monks formed the Sthaviravada (Elders) school, while the liberal majority formed the Mahasanghika school. This set the ideological foundation for the Hinayana and Mahayana split centuries later at the 4th Council.

Q4. During the Sangam Age, the land of Tamilakam was divided into five distinct ecological eco-zones known as 'Thinai'. Which of the following pairs of Thinai and its primary economic activity is NOT correctly matched?

- [A] Kurinji (Hilly tracks) — Hunting and gathering
- [B] Mullai (Pastoral/Forest spaces) — Cattle rearing and herding
- [C] Marutham (Wetland agricultural plains) — Fishing and salt manufacturing
- [D] Palai (Parched/Desert zone) — Plunder and cattle lifting

Exam Source: SSC CGL (2024), TNPSC Group 1 & 2, test of socio-economic historical terms.

Correct Answer: [C]

Detailed Explanation: The mismatch is in [C]. Marutham represents fertile, wetland agricultural plains where the primary economic activity was rice cultivation. Fishing and salt manufacturing were the characteristic economic activities of the *Neithal* (coastal/maritime) landscape. Kurinji, Mullai, and Palai are correctly paired with their classic geographic and economic definitions.

Q5. Which celebrated ancient Sangam literary masterpiece handles ethics, political economy, and love, and is highly revered as the 'Tamil Veda' or the 'Bible of the Tamil Land'?

- [A] Silappadikaram by Ilango Adigal
- [B] Tirukkural by Saint Thiruvalluvar
- [C] Manimegalai by Chithalai Sattanar
- [D] Tolkappiyam by Tolkappiyar

Exam Source: SSC CHSL (2023), RPF SI ancient literature module.

Correct Answer: [B]

Detailed Explanation: The *Tirukkural* (or Kural), authored by the revered poet-saint Thiruvalluvar, consists of 1,330 couplets (kurals) divided into three main sections: Aram (Virtue/Ethics), Porul (G■■■/Wealth/Political Economy), and Inbam (Love). Because of its universal values and profound influence on Tamil culture, it is widely honored as the 'Tamil Veda'.